

What are the real effects of cyberbullying? [Test S2 2022-2023]

/ 10

Seeker, 10/31/2014, 3min09s

1. According to a study in School Psychology Quaterly, ... 1
 - ☐ girls are verbally bullied by boys of their age.
 - ☒ cyberbullying gets more important when kids get older.
 - ☐ kids are all bullied in the same way, regardless of their gender.
2. How many kids were cyberbullied in the year prior to the study? 1
 - ☒ 7% ☐ 14% ☐ 25%
3. What is the problem with smartphones? 1
 - ☒ You can suffer from cyberbullying anywhere and at any time.
 - ☐ 63% of teens are addicted to them and that number is growing.
 - ☐ Bullies can locate you and physically harass you anywhere you are.
4. Most of the time, cyberbullying lasts... 1
 - ☒ less than a month. ☐ for three to six months. ☐ more than a year.
5. What consequences on their health can victims of harassment experience? 2

(Two answers expected among several possibilities)

 - ⇒ increases in anxiety disorders, panic disorder, and depression
 - ⇒ higher levels of C-reactive protein, which is a biomarker which has been linked to higher cardiovascular risks
6. Why do teens struggle more with cyberbullying than with classic bullying? 1

simply because online is more solitary. No one comes to the victim's defense, and it's difficult for a victim to work out differences with their bully. This isn't just a kid's issue either.
7. Other than kids, who usually suffers from cyberbullying? 1
 - ⇒ Climate scientists
 - ⇒ Journalists
8. Who created a software that can cut bullying comments by 93.43%? 1
 - ☐ Google. ☐ Norton. ☒ A teenager.
9. After using the software, most people... 1
 - ☐ erased their comments.
 - ☒ rethought their comments.
 - ☐ sent their original comments.

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https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DJGTccn_8us

Our parents had regular bullies, they stole their lunch money on the walk to school and beat them up out of sight of the teachers. But cyberbullies don't have to go far to get out of sight or find victims. A study in School Psychology Quarterly found that when it comes to bullying, girls were more likely to be victims of verbal or relational assaults, while boys were more likely to be physically bullied. And as kids age, the physical bullying peters out, and cyberbullying increases.

According to research in the journal Psicothema, one in four teens were cyberbullied in the year prior to the study. And unlike old school bullying, the internet is in your pocket all the time thanks to smartphones. 63% of the teens said they never shut off their phones, so they can be bullied anywhere, and as more people carry devices like phones and laptops, the numbers will only grow. The long-term effects of this round-the-clock bullying are just beginning to be studied. And according to the same study, with most, cyberbullying lasted less than a month. But 4% of teens said they'd been regularly cyberbullied for three to six months, and 3% for more than a year! That's a lot of bullying!

And it doesn't stop there. The Boston Children's Hospital released a study earlier this year that says even though the bullying does stop eventually, the harm sticks around forever. People who experienced harassment at any age experienced worse mental and physical health later in life. Plus, increased depressive symptoms and lower self-worth. A separate study in the Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences found victims of bullying had increases in anxiety disorders, panic disorder, and depression. And additionally, people who were bullied had higher levels of C-reactive protein, which is a biomarker which has been linked to higher cardiovascular risks. Bullies on the other hand had lower levels of that protein.

Anyway, the reasons aren't really clear, but a study by the Family Institute at Northwestern University said that teenagers have more difficulties processing and dealing with cyberbullying than classic bullying, simply because online is more solitary. No one comes to the victim's defense, and it's difficult for a victim to work out differences with their bully. This isn't just a kid's issue either. Climate scientists are cyberbullied constantly, Gavin Schmidt, a climate scientist for NASA told Scientific American he gets a lot of hate mail and intimidating letters every time he publishes anything. Journalist, myself included, also experience bullying on a regular basis. It's not easy to put your face on YouTube knowing that everything you say or do will be commented on, usually negatively.

Cyberbullying is truly horrible to the people it affects. And it's becoming such a growing problem, a 13-year-old girl from Chicago entered a project in the Google Science Fair that cut bullying comments by 93.43%. Her invention? A piece of software that identifies a mean comment and simply asks if they're sure they want to post it. Seriously, almost everyone who used it reconsidered their comments.

Luckily, there's another software out there to protect you from cyberbullying and other online dangers, so a big thank you to Norton for protecting the vulnerable and for sponsoring the news.